



NEW SPRING: The swearing-in of Gilani (above right); and release of Chaudhry (centre) bring fresh hope

tion at a time when democracy has not taken root and conditions are "fragile".

The restoration of the pre-November 3 judiciary also has the potential to upset the delicate "political reconciliation" initiated by Musharraf by throwing into question the withdrawal of corruption cases against, among others, the PPP Co-Chairman Asif Ali Zardari. On the other hand, Sharif, has made the restoration of the judges his single condition for being part of the PPP-led coalition. Gilani is stuck between a rock and a hard place and it is little wonder that even as he set the judges free, he appealed to them to let parliament resolve the issue rather than take the matter to the streets.

The economy is the other major cause for concern as inflation mounts and the boom of the previous six years